

PART 6: MONSTERS

This section expands the monster lists given in the D&D® Basic rules to cover the many new monsters that are found in the wilderness. The monsters are listed in alphabetical order to aid quick reference.

An asterisk (*) following the monster's name means that silver, magic, or special weapons are needed to fight the creature. Monsters thus noted should be used with caution.

Armor Class (AC) is a number like the AC of the characters. It is based on the armor worn by NPCs or the toughness of the monster's hide and its speed and dexterity.

Hit Dice gives the number of 8-sided dice (d8) to be rolled, as well as any adjustments (+ or -) to determine the monster's hit points. A monster's hit dice are used as a guide for the DM to use when designing an adventure for certain level characters. This should be adjusted for the presence of special items and character types at the DM's discretion. As in the D&D Basic rules, one asterisk after the Hit Dice means that the *special abilities bonus* should be added when the DM gives out experience points; two asterisks mean that double the special abilities bonus should be awarded.

Move gives the number of feet a monster moves in one *turn*. The number in parenthesis is the number of feet moved in one combat round. Some monsters have special movement rates; for example, swimming, burrowing, flying, and moving across a web.

Attacks this refers to the number and type of attacks that a monster may make in one round. Humanoid creatures usually use weapons while other monsters have more natural forms of attacks, such as claws, bites, horns, pincers, and so on. Some notes on special attacks follow the section on damage.

Damage gives the damage caused by a monster's successful attack. The damage ranges are given in the same order as the corresponding types of attacks listed under **Attacks**. (When a monster makes a successful attack the DM should roll dice corresponding to the damage range to determine the damage done, i.e. (3-18) = 3d6. Special attacks may also be listed under damage, such as poison, petrification (turn to stone), paralysis, energy drain, and so on.) Some notes on special attacks follow:

Charge: When a creature rushes into melee combat this is called a charge. A charge cannot be made after the opponents have closed to melee range, nor can it be made in forest, mountain, jungle, swamp, or broken terrain which prevents running. The charging creature must move at least 20 yds. A successful charge attack by a creature with large horns or tusks does double damage to an opponent. Hits on charging creatures by spears or pole arms braced against the ground will do double damage.

Continuous Damage: Certain types of attacks (constriction, blood drain, swallow, etc.) will continue to do damage automatically after the first hit is scored. Usually the monster must be killed to rescue the victim.

Energy Drain: A successful hit by certain **undead** monsters will drain energy from the victim. Unlike other special attacks, there is no saving throw against an energy drain. Each energy drain will destroy one level of experience of a character, or one hit die of a monster. The creature drained of energy loses all the benefits (attack level, saving throws, spells, etc.) of the former level. This effect cannot be cured. (Note: in the D&D® Companion Supplement rules, there is a magical way to cure energy drains.)

Swallow: An attack in which the opponent is swallowed whole. This attack always succeeds on a "to hit" roll of 20. This number may be adjusted for larger creatures. A swallowed creature will take the given amount of damage *each round* until either the character or the monster dies. A swallowed creature with an edged weapon may attack the creature from inside, with a -4 penalty on the "to hit" rolls. Being swallowed may have other effects, depending on the monster (paralysis, loss of consciousness, etc.). In 6 game turns after death, the victim will be completely digested and not recoverable.

Swoop: This is a diving attack, used by certain flying monsters. If the flier has surprise the swoop attack does double damage. Swoop attacks cannot be attempted against opponents hidden by dense forest or jungle cover. In addition, on a roll of 18+, the creature has grasped the victim and will try to fly away. If the character is too heavy, the monster will release him or her and attack normally the next round.

Trample: This attack is an attempt by a monster to use its superior size and weight to crush an opponent. Creatures with a trample attack have a 75% chance per round of using it, and a 25% chance of using a different attack. Trample attacks add +4 to a monster's "to hit" roll against creatures of man-size or smaller. The DM may wish to allow herds of 20 or more normal animals, such as horses, to stampede and trample. A herd will cause 1-20 points of damage when trampling.

No. Appearing or Number Appearing gives a range for the number of monsters encountered. This number should be adjusted by the DM to provide a fair challenge to a party of characters.

The first number gives the range of monsters found in a dungeon level equal to the monsters' level. Monsters may, of course, be found on levels greater than or less than the monsters' level. When encountered on levels less than the monsters' level there should usually be fewer and when found on dungeon levels greater than the monsters' level there should probably be more.

The number in parenthesis is the range for the number of monsters encountered in the wilderness (as well as the number encountered in the monsters' home or lair if found in a dungeon). Monster lairs in the wilderness will usually have 5 times the normal number.

A zero means that the monster will *only* be encountered in a dungeon (or wilderness) if specially placed by the DM.

Save As gives the saving throw character class and level the monster saves at. Unintelligent monsters usually save at half their monster level, with fractions rounded up. Monsters will normally save as fighters. Some monsters which are enchanted, magical in nature or have certain special abilities will have their saves adjusted as noted in the description.

Morale is used to determine the reactions of monsters in combat. The DM may wish to adjust this number to reflect the situation. To test morale, 2d6 are rolled, and if the number is greater than the creature's morale, the monster will try to run away or surrender.

Treasure Type gives the letter of the treasure type usually found in the monster's lair. Wandering monsters are unlikely to be carrying treasure unless individual treasure type is given. Unintelligent monsters usually do not have treasure; though treasure may be found on the body of nearby victims.

Alignment shows whether the monster is Lawful, Neutral, or Chaotic. Unintelligent monsters are usually of Neutral alignment. The DM should try to play monsters according to their alignments.